managing directors (immediately subordinate to the president) were a former Brazilian finance minister, Joaquim Levy, and a former Chinese senior finance ministry official, Shaolin Yang.

The BRICS Club Coordinates on Capital Controls and Global Imbalances

The final element of BRICS cooperation around reforming the Bretton Woods institutions from within has been aimed at changing IMF economic ideas and policies. For example, emerging powers have been frustrated with the IMF's policy of promoting capital liberalization and the perceived neoliberal bias within IMF surveillance activities.[66] Throughout the several financial crises experienced by many middle-income countries from Latin America to Asia to Russia from the 1980s through the 2000s, these institutions became the bulwark of neoliberal and financial interests, imposing conditionality and structural adjustment onto the debtors to restructure their economies in support of economic liberalization. IMF surveillance practices follow closely the American model of economic governance as in the so-called Washington Consensus.[67] Many developing economies have been scrutinized by the IMF and found wanting in terms of IMF preferences for economic openness and prudent macroeconomic management, while the United States and some other advanced economies have escaped systematic surveillance. After the global financial crisis, the BRICS repeatedly emphasized in G20 meetings and in joint communiqués from the sidelines of these and similar gatherings that the IMF needs "better-focused even-handed surveillance across all IMF members, especially . . . advanced economies with major international financial centers and large cross-border capital flows."[68]

More recently, some of the BRICS (notably Russia, China, and to some extent India) have been gradually dismantling, or in Russia's case, eliminating capital controls. For China, incremental movement toward the free flow of financial capital, while retaining managed control, is connected to the plan to internationalize the RMB. Nonetheless, all the BRICS share a common aversion to IMF pressure, preferring to protect their autonomy and financial stability through national policy discretion. Like many other emerging economies, the BRICS believe that capital controls are a necessary part of the arsenal of emerging economies exposed to external financial contagion. The IMF's drive in the 1990s to amend its Articles of Agreement to force member-states to endorse eventual full capital account liberalization